

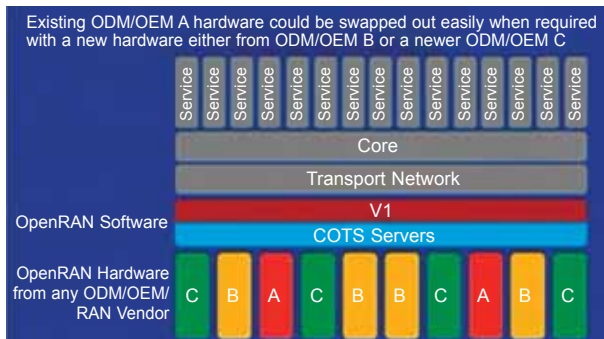


Fig. 5: Open RAN deployment model

This results in a mixture of vendors within the RAN space as opposed to just one or two.

Best of breed. O-RAN brings more flexibility in choosing components from a variety of vendors as per its standards. This fosters an ecosystem of vendors and promotes supply-chain diversification and price competition among vendors.

Reduced cost. O-RAN plays a very crucial role in reducing cost and time to market by enabling rapid innovation, vendor diversification, and higher automation.

Spur innovation. When functionality is 100%, further enhancement to the software can be done proficiently.

Hardware-software development. 5G creates new monetisation opportunities.

Telecommunication experts expect their partners to offer 5G on both hardware and software front. Hence, more opportunities can be found in this area as well.

However, there are some challenges faced in the use of O-RAN as well, which cannot be ignored. The two most important challenges to take note of are:

Security. Network security is one of the major challenges as different vendors follow different security protocols.

Openness. Since it is open sourced, it is susceptible to threats.

5G has evolved and is still evolving at a much higher pace. Mobile network operators are benefited tremendously with O-RAN standards. More new features will be introduced to it eventually that will make it even more economical and will improve the hardware and software integration. With this context as a user, you shall be able to make an informed decision for yourself. **EFY**

This article has been put together from a tech talk session at OSI 2021 by Binitha MT - Dell Technologies, Subhankar Adak - Dell EMC, and Krutika Dhanakshirur - Dell EMC and has been transcribed and curated by EFY's Laveesh Kocher, a tech enthusiast with a knack for open source exploration and research.

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